

Nokia	Nokia
2310	2626
24.57	26.90
Candybar	Candybar
105.4 x 43.9 x 19.05	104 x 43 x 18
85	91
8	8
6	6
6/6	6/6
✓	✓
Dual-band	Dual-band
128 x 128	128 x 128
65	65
200	300
Symbian	Symbian S40
✓	✓
6	6
✓	✓
✓	✓
✓	✓
✗	✓
✗/✗/✗	✓/✗/✗
✗/✗/✗/✗	✗/✗/✗/✗
✗	✗
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
NA	NA
✓	✓
✗	✓
✓	✓
400/360	300/180
✗/✓/✓	✗/✓/✓
15.75	15.00
7	7
6	6
7	7
8	8
2	9
3	4
NA/NA	NA/NA
8.61	6.62
48.94	48.51
3,449	4,489



+ Good UI
- Flimsy 4-way rocker



+ Good UI
- Expensive

Contact Sheet			
Cell Phone Test			
Brand	Company	Phone	E-mail
BenQ-Siemens	BenQ-Siemens India Pvt Ltd	9810718821	Sales.EnquiryIn@BenQ.com
bleu	Pratham Telecom	022-28769381	avinash@sagemindia.com
Intex	Intex Technologies	011-41610190	amitsaxena@intextechnologies.com
Motorola	NA	NA	NA
Nokia	Nokia India	0124-41990000	www.nokia.co.in
Sony Ericsson	Sony Ericsson Mobile Comm. Int. AB	022-39011111	questions.in@support.sonyericsson.com

Image quality

Of the two contenders here, we found the still image quality similar, while the video capture quality of the Intex infi was better than that of the bleu 450X.

The Winners!

The SE CyberShot K550i is the only phone that specialises in the camera department, with features such as a 2 MP camera with flash and auto-focus. This was reflected in its imaging scores. It supports high-speed Internet standards such as HSCSD and EDGE. This sleek phone with its equally sleek interface, in addition to good performance and at a decent price of Rs 11,995 has been adjudged the winner of the Digit Best Buy Gold award in the The Upper Crest category.

Close behind was the colourful slider, the Nokia 5300, which has one of the fastest interfaces. It has media control buttons to enhance accessibility to your music, and also comes bundled with a good pair of in-ear earphones which sound really good. Voice clarity is good, and signal reception, excellent. We award it the Digit Best Buy Silver in the The Upper Crest category.

The candybar bleu 651X has almost everything you'd expect from a multimedia phone. It has a 2-megapixel camera with flash, and a good-looking media player that can be controlled via the media control buttons. It even doubles up as a webcam when plugged into a PC. And good signal reception, good looks, and a not-too-heavy price tag of Rs 8,299 means the bleu 651X takes the Digit Best Buy Gold in the Talk And Click category.

The beautiful BenQ-Siemens CL71, a slider, is the only one with a large address book capacity (1,000). Good keypad layout, speed, and superior audio clarity mean the BenQ-Siemens CL71 wins the Digit Best Buy Silver in the Talk And Click category.

In the Just A Phone category, the two camera phones scored the highest. The stylish bleu 450X, which is a multimedia phone with support for MP3, good voice clarity, and a decent interface, while being the only one with expandable memory in this category wins the Digit Best Buy Gold.

The Intex infi, the other camera phone, has a better camera with 1.3-MP resolution. Though priced the highest in this category, this mobile has good voice clarity, and supports Hindi SMSes. The media player is decent, and is the only one that has graphics equalisers. It wins the Digit Best Buy Silver in the Just A Phone category.

If a camera is not very important, you can



Intex infi

A very affordable camera-mobile

definitely go with either of the two Nokia phones: they offer almost everything else. They look decent and have better user interfaces than the rest of the phones. Built ruggedly, supporting Hindi SMS and with FM radio, these are definitely worth a look.

A Closing Note

We have left out the crème-de-la-crème of mobile phones, which will be reviewed in a separate shootout later. But as has been the trend, it is only a matter of months before this category trickles down to mass-affordable levels.

As more players enter the mobile arena, competition is forcing cuts in subscription costs. CDMA coming in has served as catalyst to the already speedy process of plummeting call rates, which are already rivalling those of landlines.

Landlines are still more affordable than mobiles, but they aren't, well, mobile! But they have started offering services such as ADSL. The landline will never die, we think, and these technologies will continue to co-exist for a long time to come.

We hope we've cleared, in this article, some of the fog for you when it comes to choosing a phone. Even if you upgrade your phone often, worry not-we'll most likely carry a shootout at about the same time next year! ■

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